

MASTER SERVICES AGREEMENT

Managed IT Infrastructure and Cloud Operations Services

Contract Reference: NB-MSA-2026-0417 | Version: Execution Copy 3.2 | Date: 15 August 2026

Between: Meridian Logistics Group PLC ("Client") and NorthBridge Digital Services Ltd ("Service Provider")

Classification: Commercial in Confidence

This Master Services Agreement (the "Agreement") is entered into on 15 August 2026 (the "Effective Date") by and between **Meridian Logistics Group PLC**, a public limited company incorporated in England and Wales with company number 04471982, whose registered office is at One Meridian Quay, Salford M50 3XZ, United Kingdom (the "Client"), and **NorthBridge Digital Services Ltd**, a private limited company incorporated in England and Wales with company number 07723145, whose registered office is at 40 Fenwick Street, Liverpool L2 7NB, United Kingdom (the "Service Provider" or "NorthBridge").

RECITALS. WHEREAS the Client operates a pan-European logistics and freight-forwarding business supported by a hybrid IT estate comprising two co-location data centres, public cloud workloads and approximately 430 managed server instances; and WHEREAS the Client wishes to appoint a single service provider to manage, operate, monitor and continuously improve that estate; and WHEREAS the Service Provider has represented that it possesses the skills, certifications, personnel and financial standing necessary to deliver the Services in accordance with the Service Levels; NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants contained herein, the parties agree as follows.

1. DEFINITIONS AND INTERPRETATION

- 1.1 "Charges" means the Monthly Base Charge, the Transition Charge, any Project Charges and any other amounts payable by the Client under this Agreement, as set out in Schedule C.
- 1.2 "Contract Year" means each successive period of twelve (12) months commencing on the Service Commencement Date or an anniversary thereof.
- 1.3 "Deliverable" means any report, design document, configuration artefact, script, runbook, dashboard, or other work product created by the Service Provider specifically for the Client in the course of providing the Services.
- 1.4 "Incident" means any unplanned interruption to, or reduction in the quality of, a Service, classified according to the Priority Levels defined in Schedule B.
- 1.5 "Key Positions" means the roles identified in Clause 9.2, including the Account Director, Service Delivery Manager, Lead Security Engineer and Principal Cloud Architect.
- 1.6 "Managed Environment" means the Client infrastructure described in Schedule A, comprising as at the Effective Date 430 server instances, 18 network core devices, 2 co-location facilities (Manchester and Frankfurt) and the Client's landing zones in Oracle Cloud Infrastructure and Microsoft Azure.
- 1.7 "Service Credits" means the credits payable by the Service Provider for Service Level Failures, calculated in accordance with Clause 7 and Schedule B.
- 1.8 "Service Levels" means the performance standards set out in Schedule B.
- 1.9 "Service Commencement Date" means 1 November 2026, or such later date as is agreed under the Transition Plan pursuant to Clause 3.
- 1.10 In this Agreement, references to Clauses and Schedules are to clauses of and schedules to this Agreement; headings are for convenience only; "including" means including without limitation; and references to a statute include any amendment or re-enactment of it.

2. SCOPE OF SERVICES

- 2.1 The Service Provider shall provide the following service towers, each as further described in Schedule A: (a) 24x7x365 service desk and monitoring; (b) infrastructure and platform operations for the Managed Environment; (c) cloud operations and FinOps for the Client's OCI and Azure tenancies; (d) network and connectivity management; (e) backup, storage and data lifecycle management; (f) security operations, patching and vulnerability management; and (g) continuous service improvement.
- 2.2 The Services include all activities reasonably incidental to the service towers listed in Clause 2.1, whether or not expressly described in Schedule A, if such activities are consistent with the practice of a well-managed provider of comparable services (the "Sweep Clause").
- 2.3 The Service Provider shall provide the Services in accordance with Good Industry Practice, ITIL 4 aligned processes, and all laws applicable to the Service Provider in its role as a provider of the Services.
- 2.4 New services materially outside the scope of Schedule A shall be agreed through the Change Control Procedure in Clause 8.5 and charged at the Rate Card in Schedule C, Part 3.

3. SERVICE COMMENCEMENT AND TRANSITION

- 3.1 The Service Provider shall perform the transition of services from the Client's incumbent arrangements in accordance with the transition plan agreed by the parties (the "Transition Plan"), which shall provide for a transition period of not more than ten (10) weeks from the Effective Date.
- 3.2 The one-time Transition Charge shall be **USD 95,000**, payable in two instalments: fifty per cent (50%) on the Effective Date and fifty per cent (50%) on achievement of the Service Commencement Milestone, subject to the Client's acceptance in accordance with the Transition Plan acceptance criteria.
- 3.3 If the Service Commencement Milestone is delayed by more than fifteen (15) Business Days for reasons attributable to the Service Provider, the Client shall be entitled to liquidated damages of USD 2,500 per Business Day of delay, capped at fifty per cent (50%) of the Transition Charge.
- 3.4 During the Transition Period, the Service Provider shall conduct a documented knowledge acquisition programme, a baseline security assessment, and a full asset discovery reconciled against the configuration management database within thirty (30) days of the Effective Date.

4. TERM AND RENEWAL

- 4.1 This Agreement commences on the Effective Date and, unless terminated earlier in accordance with Clause 19, continues for an initial term of **thirty-six (36) months** from the Service Commencement Date (the "Initial Term").
- 4.2 On expiry of the Initial Term, this Agreement shall automatically renew for successive renewal terms of **twelve (12) months** each (each a "Renewal Term"), unless either party gives written notice of non-renewal at least **ninety (90) days** before the end of the Initial Term or the then-current Renewal Term.
- 4.3 The Charges applicable during any Renewal Term shall be the Charges in effect at the end of the preceding term, adjusted in accordance with Clause 6 (Price Adjustment and Benchmarking).

5. CHARGES AND PAYMENT

- 5.1 In consideration of the Services, the Client shall pay the Service Provider a Monthly Base Charge of **USD 184,500** per calendar month, invoiced monthly in arrears.
- 5.2 The Monthly Base Charge covers the Managed Environment baseline of 430 server instances. Instances added above the baseline shall be charged at USD 310 per instance per month; the Monthly Base Charge shall be reduced by USD 260 per instance per month for reductions below the baseline, floor 350 instances. If the managed estate exceeds 500 instances for three consecutive months, a volume discount of **five per cent (5%)** shall apply to the entire Monthly Base Charge for so long as the estate remains above that threshold.
- 5.3 All invoices are payable within **thirty (30) days** of the date of a valid invoice ("Net 30"). The Client may withhold payment of amounts disputed in good faith, provided the undisputed balance is paid when due and the dispute is notified within fifteen (15) days of invoice receipt.
- 5.4 Late payment of undisputed amounts shall bear interest at **1.5% per month** (or the maximum permitted by law, if lower), accruing daily from the due date until payment.
- 5.5 All Charges are exclusive of VAT and similar taxes, which shall be payable by the Client at the prevailing rate. Each party is responsible for taxes on its own income and personnel.
- 5.6 Travel and expenses are included in the Charges except for Client-requested travel outside the United Kingdom and Germany, which shall be recharged at cost with no administrative uplift, subject to the Client's travel policy and prior written approval for items exceeding USD 1,000.

6. PRICE ADJUSTMENT AND BENCHMARKING

- 6.1 The Monthly Base Charge is fixed for Contract Year 1. From the commencement of Contract Year 2 and annually thereafter, the Monthly Base Charge may be adjusted by the percentage change in the UK Consumer Prices Index (CPI) over the preceding twelve months, **capped at four per cent (4%) per annum**. No adjustment shall be applied retrospectively.
- 6.2 Not more than once in any period of twelve (12) months following the first anniversary of the Service Commencement Date, the Client may appoint an independent benchmarker from the agreed panel (Gartner, ISG or NelsonHall) to compare the Charges against a peer group of comparable deals (the "Benchmark").
- 6.3 If the Benchmark concludes that the Charges exceed the peer-group median by more than **seven point five per cent (7.5%)**, the parties shall negotiate in good faith an adjustment; failing agreement within sixty (60) days, the Charges shall be reduced to the level of the peer-group median plus 7.5% with effect from the first day of the month following the Benchmark report. Benchmarking costs are borne by the Client unless a reduction is triggered, in which case they are shared equally.

7. SERVICE LEVELS AND SERVICE CREDITS

- 7.1 The Service Provider shall perform the Services so as to meet or exceed the Service Levels in Schedule B, including **Managed Environment availability of 99.95%** measured monthly across the production estate, excluding Agreed Maintenance Windows.
- 7.2 Incident response and resolution targets are set out in Schedule B. For a Priority 1 Incident the Service Provider shall respond within **fifteen (15) minutes** and restore service within **four (4) hours**; for a Priority 2 Incident, response within one (1) hour and restoration within eight (8) hours.
- 7.3 If the Service Provider fails to achieve a Service Level in any month (a "Service Level Failure"), the Client shall be entitled to Service Credits calculated in accordance with Schedule B, Part 2, up to an aggregate monthly cap of **ten per cent (10%) of the Monthly Base Charge**.
- 7.4 Service Credits are the Client's primary but not exclusive remedy for Service Level Failures and are without prejudice to the Client's right to claim damages for the same failure, subject to Clause 17 and after giving credit for Service Credits already paid.
- 7.5 If the same Service Level is failed in **three (3) consecutive months**, or availability falls below 99.50% in any month, the failure shall constitute a material breach entitling the Client to terminate under Clause 19.2 without a further cure period.
- 7.6 The Service Provider shall operate a continuous improvement programme with a target of a two per cent (2%) year-on-year reduction in Priority 1 and Priority 2 Incident volumes, reported quarterly.

8. GOVERNANCE, REPORTING AND CHANGE CONTROL

- 8.1 The parties shall operate a three-tier governance model: (a) a **monthly** Service Review Meeting chaired by the Service Delivery Manager; (b) a **quarterly** Business Review attended by the Account Director and the Client's Head of Technology; and (c) an annual Executive Steering Review.
- 8.2 The Service Provider shall deliver a monthly service report within five (5) Business Days of month end, covering Service Level performance, Incident and Problem trends, capacity and availability forecasts, security posture, Service Credits accrued, and improvement actions.
- 8.3 The Service Provider shall maintain and share a rolling twelve-month technology roadmap for the Managed Environment, refreshed every six months.
- 8.4 The Client's dependencies are limited to those expressly stated in Schedule A, Part 4. The Service Provider is excused from a Service Level Failure only to the extent it demonstrates the failure was directly caused by a documented Client dependency failure.
- 8.5 Changes to this Agreement or the Services shall follow the Change Control Procedure: a written change request, an impact assessment within ten (10) Business Days, and written acceptance by both parties before implementation. Neither party may unreasonably withhold agreement to changes required by law.

9. PERSONNEL AND KEY POSITIONS

- 9.1 The Service Provider shall ensure all personnel providing the Services are suitably qualified, vetted to BS 7858 standard, and bound by confidentiality obligations no less protective than Clause 14.
- 9.2 The individuals appointed to Key Positions shall not be replaced or materially reassigned without **thirty (30) days'** prior written notice to the Client and the Client's approval of the proposed replacement, such approval not to be unreasonably withheld. Voluntary attrition of Key Positions shall not exceed one role per Contract Year without a remediation plan.
- 9.3 Not more than **forty per cent (40%)** of service delivery FTEs may be located outside the United Kingdom and the European Economic Area. All personnel with privileged access to Client Data must be located in the UK or EEA.
- 9.4 The Client may require removal of any Service Provider personnel on documented grounds of misconduct, security concern or persistent underperformance, and the Service Provider shall replace such personnel within ten (10) Business Days at no additional charge.

10. SUBCONTRACTING

- 10.1 The Service Provider shall not subcontract any material part of the Services without the Client's prior written consent, not to be unreasonably withheld. The approved subcontractors as at the Effective Date are listed in Schedule A, Part 5 (co-location facilities management and out-of-hours eyes-on-glass monitoring only).
- 10.2 The Service Provider remains fully liable for the acts and omissions of its subcontractors as if they were its own, and shall flow down obligations materially equivalent to Clauses 11, 14 and 22 to each subcontractor.

11. DATA PROTECTION AND INFORMATION SECURITY

- 11.1 Each party shall comply with applicable data protection laws, including UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. The Service Provider acts as processor of Client personal data; the data processing particulars are set out in Schedule D, Part 3.
- 11.2 The Service Provider shall maintain certification to **ISO/IEC 27001** for the services in scope and shall provide a **SOC 2 Type II** report annually, covering security, availability and confidentiality trust criteria, at no additional charge.
- 11.3 The Service Provider shall notify the Client of any actual or reasonably suspected Security Incident affecting Client Data **within twenty-four (24) hours** of becoming aware of it, and shall provide a written incident report within five (5) Business Days.
- 11.4 Client Data shall be encrypted at rest using AES-256 and in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher. Client Data shall not be stored or processed outside the UK and EEA without the Client's prior written consent.
- 11.5 The Service Provider shall apply critical security patches within fourteen (14) days of vendor release (seventy-two (72) hours for actively exploited vulnerabilities rated CVSS 9.0 or above) and shall conduct quarterly vulnerability scans and an annual independent penetration test, sharing summary results with the Client.
- 11.6 On termination or expiry, the Service Provider shall return or securely erase all Client Data in accordance with NIST SP 800-88 within thirty (30) days and certify erasure in writing.

12. BUSINESS CONTINUITY AND DISASTER RECOVERY

- 12.1 The Service Provider shall maintain and annually test a business continuity plan for its own delivery organisation, and shall operate the Client's disaster recovery solution to achieve a **Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of four (4) hours** and a **Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of fifteen (15) minutes** for Tier 1 systems identified in Schedule A, Part 2.
- 12.2 The Service Provider shall conduct **two (2)** full disaster recovery tests per Contract Year, including one unannounced failover test, and shall remediate test findings within agreed timescales. Test reports shall be provided to the Client within ten (10) Business Days.
- 12.3 Failure to meet the RTO or RPO in a declared disaster or in two consecutive DR tests constitutes a material breach for the purposes of Clause 19.2.

13. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS

- 13.1 All right, title and interest in and to the Deliverables shall **vest in the Client** on creation. The Service Provider hereby assigns to the Client, with full title guarantee, all intellectual property rights in the Deliverables, including by way of present assignment of future rights.
- 13.2 The Service Provider retains ownership of its pre-existing materials, tools, and generic know-how ("Provider Background IP"). The Service Provider grants the Client a perpetual, irrevocable, worldwide, royalty-free, non-exclusive licence to use Provider Background IP to the extent embedded in the Deliverables or reasonably required to receive the benefit of the Services, including after termination.
- 13.3 Nothing in this Agreement transfers ownership of either party's trademarks or of third-party software, which is licensed under its own terms.

14. CONFIDENTIALITY

- 14.1 Each party shall keep confidential all Confidential Information of the other party and use it solely for the purposes of this Agreement, disclosing it only to personnel, professional advisers and approved subcontractors with a need to know who are bound by equivalent obligations.
- 14.2 The obligations in this Clause 14 survive for **three (3) years** after termination or expiry of this Agreement, save that obligations in respect of trade secrets and Client Data survive indefinitely.
- 14.3 The standard exceptions apply (information that is public without breach, independently developed, rightfully received from a third party, or required to be disclosed by law or a regulator, subject to notice where lawful).

15. WARRANTIES

- 15.1 The Service Provider warrants that: (a) the Services will be performed with reasonable skill and care by appropriately qualified personnel and in accordance with Good Industry Practice; (b) it holds and will maintain all licences and consents required to perform the Services; (c) the Deliverables will conform to their specifications for ninety (90) days from acceptance; and (d) it will not knowingly introduce any virus, backdoor or other malicious code into the Managed Environment.

- 15.2 The Client warrants that it has the right to grant the access to systems, premises and third-party materials contemplated by Schedule A.
- 15.3 Except as expressly stated, all conditions, warranties and terms implied by statute or common law are excluded to the fullest extent permitted by law.

16. INDEMNITIES

- 16.1 The Service Provider shall indemnify and hold harmless the Client against all losses, damages, costs and expenses arising from: (a) any claim that the Services or Deliverables infringe a third party's intellectual property rights; (b) death, personal injury or damage to tangible property caused by the Service Provider's negligence; (c) the Service Provider's breach of Clause 11 (Data Protection and Information Security), including regulatory fines to the extent lawfully recoverable; and (d) fraud or fraudulent misrepresentation.
- 16.2 The IP indemnity in Clause 16.1(a) does not apply to the extent a claim arises from Client materials, Client-directed designs, or combinations not supplied or recommended by the Service Provider. The Service Provider may, at its option, procure the right to continue use, or modify or replace the infringing item without material loss of functionality.
- 16.3 The indemnified party shall give prompt notice, allow the indemnifying party to conduct the defence, and provide reasonable cooperation at the indemnifying party's expense.

17. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

- 17.1 Nothing in this Agreement limits or excludes liability for: death or personal injury caused by negligence; fraud or fraudulent misrepresentation; or any liability that cannot be limited by law.
- 17.2 Subject to Clauses 17.1 and 17.3, each party's total aggregate liability arising in any Contract Year, whether in contract, tort (including negligence), breach of statutory duty or otherwise, shall not exceed an amount equal to **the total Charges paid or payable in the twelve (12) months preceding the event giving rise to the claim** (or, in Contract Year 1, twelve times the Monthly Base Charge).
- 17.3 The cap in Clause 17.2 shall be increased to **three (3) times** that amount in respect of the Service Provider's liability arising from breach of Clause 11 (Data Protection and Information Security) or Clause 14 (Confidentiality).
- 17.4 Neither party is liable for loss of profits, loss of revenue, loss of anticipated savings or indirect or consequential loss, except that the following are recoverable as direct losses: (a) costs of restoring or reconstituting lost or corrupted data; (b) costs of procuring replacement services; and (c) regulatory fines recoverable under Clause 16.1(c).
- 17.5 Service Credits paid in respect of a Service Level Failure shall be deducted from any damages awarded in respect of the same failure.

18. INSURANCE

- 18.1 The Service Provider shall maintain for the Term and for two (2) years thereafter, with insurers rated A- or better: (a) cyber liability insurance of not less than **USD 10,000,000** per claim and in the aggregate; (b) professional indemnity insurance of not less than **USD 10,000,000** per claim; (c) commercial general liability insurance of not less than **USD 5,000,000** per occurrence; and (d) employer's liability insurance as required by law.
- 18.2 The Service Provider shall provide certificates of insurance on request and shall notify the Client of any cancellation or material reduction in cover within ten (10) Business Days.

19. TERMINATION

- 19.1 **Termination for convenience.** The Client may terminate this Agreement or any service tower for convenience at any time after the first twelve (12) months of the Initial Term by giving not less than **ninety (90) days'** written notice, subject to payment of a termination fee equal to **three (3) months of the then-current Monthly Base Charge** (pro-rated for partial tower termination). No termination fee is payable for termination effective on or after the end of month 30.
- 19.2 **Termination for cause.** Either party may terminate immediately on written notice if the other party: (a) commits a material breach that is irremediable or is not remedied within thirty (30) days of written notice; (b) suffers an insolvency event; or (c) in the case of the Client's right, the circumstances in Clauses 7.5 or 12.3 arise, or a change of control of the Service Provider occurs in favour of a competitor of the Client.
- 19.3 The Client may terminate immediately without charge if a Benchmark adjustment agreed or determined under Clause 6.3 is not implemented within sixty (60) days.
- 19.4 Termination does not affect accrued rights. Clauses 11.6, 13, 14, 16, 17, 20, 23 and 24 survive termination.

20. EXIT AND TERMINATION ASSISTANCE

- 20.1 On notice of termination or expiry for any reason, the Service Provider shall provide termination assistance for a period of up to **one hundred and eighty (180) days** as requested by the Client, at the rates in the Schedule C Rate Card **without uplift**, including knowledge transfer, data migration support, documentation handover and parallel running.
- 20.2 The Service Provider shall maintain an up-to-date Exit Plan, first delivered within ninety (90) days of the Service Commencement Date and refreshed annually, describing the activities, dependencies and estimated effort for an orderly exit.
- 20.3 During any termination assistance period the Service Levels and Service Credits continue to apply in full.

21. FORCE MAJEURE

- 21.1 Neither party is liable for failure to perform (other than payment obligations) caused by events beyond its reasonable control, including natural disasters, war, terrorism, pandemic restrictions and widespread utility failure, provided the affected party promptly notifies the other and uses reasonable endeavours to mitigate. Failures of the Service Provider's subcontractors or suppliers shall **not** constitute force majeure unless caused by an event that would itself qualify.
- 21.2 If a force majeure event prevents material performance for more than thirty (30) days, the unaffected party may terminate on fourteen (14) days' notice without liability, and the Client shall receive a pro-rata refund of prepaid Charges.

22. AUDIT RIGHTS

- 22.1 The Client and its regulators may audit the Service Provider's compliance with this Agreement, including security controls and Charges calculations, **once per Contract Year** (and additionally following any Security Incident or suspected material billing error) on ten (10) Business Days' notice.
- 22.2 The Service Provider shall bear its own costs of supporting one routine audit per Contract Year; the Client bears its own audit costs. If an audit reveals overcharging exceeding three per cent (3%), the Service Provider shall refund the overcharge with interest and reimburse the Client's reasonable audit costs.

23. NON-SOLICITATION

- 23.1 Neither party shall, during the Term and for **twelve (12) months** after termination, solicit for employment any employee of the other party who was materially involved in the Services, except through general recruitment advertising not targeted at such employees.

24. GOVERNING LAW AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

- 24.1 This Agreement and any non-contractual obligations arising out of it are governed by the laws of **England and Wales**.
- 24.2 The parties shall first escalate any dispute through the governance structure: Service Delivery Managers (ten Business Days), then Account Director and Head of Technology (ten Business Days), then chief executives (ten Business Days).
- 24.3 Subject to Clause 24.2, the **courts of London, England** have exclusive jurisdiction, save that either party may seek injunctive relief in any court of competent jurisdiction.
- 24.4 Nothing in this Clause prevents the parties agreeing to refer a technical dispute to an independent expert whose decision shall be binding on matters of technical fact.

25. GENERAL

- 25.1 This Agreement, including its Schedules, is the entire agreement between the parties and supersedes all prior discussions. Neither party may assign without the other's consent, except the Client may assign to a group company on notice. No variation is effective unless in writing and signed. A person who is not a party has no rights under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999. Notices must be in writing to the registered office addresses, marked for the attention of the General Counsel, and are deemed received two Business Days after posting or on confirmed email delivery.

SCHEDULE A - DESCRIPTION OF SERVICES (SUMMARY)

Part 1 - Service Towers

Tower 1 (Service Desk & Monitoring): 24x7x365 single point of contact, event management, incident logging and triage, major incident management with a dedicated Major Incident Manager, request fulfilment against the agreed service catalogue of 64 standard requests.

Tower 2 (Infrastructure Operations): administration of 430 managed server instances (62% Linux, 38% Windows), virtualisation platform operations, capacity management with quarterly forecasts, patching per Clause 11.5, and hardware vendor coordination at the Manchester and Frankfurt co-location facilities.

Tower 3 (Cloud Operations & FinOps): operation of the Client's Oracle Cloud Infrastructure and Microsoft Azure landing zones, infrastructure-as-code pipeline maintenance, monthly cloud spend optimisation reporting with a target of 8% annualised waste reduction, and reserved-capacity planning.

Tower 4 (Network): management of 18 core devices, SD-WAN across 23 depots, firewall rulebase management with 5-Business-Day standard change turnaround, and quarterly failover testing of dual-carrier links.

Tower 5 (Backup & Storage): backup operations to the 3-2-1 pattern, monthly restore testing of a 5% sample, storage provisioning and lifecycle management across 1.9 PB of managed capacity.

Tower 6 (Security Operations): 24x7 SIEM monitoring, vulnerability management, quarterly scan cycles, annual penetration test coordination, identity and privileged access administration under the Client's IAM policy.

Part 2 - Tier 1 Systems

Tier 1 systems subject to the 4-hour RTO / 15-minute RPO commitment: the transport management system (TMS), warehouse management system (WMS), customs declaration platform, core integration bus, and the customer booking portal.

Part 4 - Client Dependencies

Client shall provide: physical access to co-location facilities within 4 business hours for scheduled work; a named change approver per application; licence entitlements for in-scope third-party software; and VPN access provisioning for authorised Service Provider personnel within 2 Business Days of request.

SCHEDULE B - SERVICE LEVEL MATRIX

Part 1 - Service Levels

Ref	Service Level	Target	Measurement
SL-01	Managed Environment availability (production)	99.95% monthly	Monitoring platform, excluding Agreed Maintenance Windows
SL-02	P1 Incident response	15 minutes	Time from detection/logging to qualified engineer engaged
SL-03	P1 Incident restoration	4 hours	95% of P1 Incidents in month
SL-04	P2 Incident response	1 hour	Time from logging to engineer engaged
SL-05	P2 Incident restoration	8 hours	90% of P2 Incidents in month
SL-06	P3 Incident restoration	3 Business Days	90% of P3 Incidents in month
SL-07	Standard service request fulfilment	5 Business Days	95% of requests in month
SL-08	First contact resolution (service desk)	70%	Monthly average
SL-09	Critical patch deployment	14 days (72 hours if CVSS >= 9.0 exploited)	100% of in-scope estate
SL-10	Backup success rate	99.5%	Scheduled jobs completed successfully, monthly
SL-11	DR test RTO achievement (Tier 1)	4 hours	Each DR test and declared disaster
SL-12	Monthly service report delivery	5 Business Days after month end	Each month

Part 2 - Service Credit Regime

Service Level Failure	Credit (% of Monthly Base Charge)
SL-01 availability 99.90% to <99.95%	2%

Service Level Failure	Credit (% of Monthly Base Charge)
SL-01 availability 99.75% to <99.90%	5%
SL-01 availability <99.75%	8%
Each other Service Level missed (per SL, per month)	1%
Aggregate monthly cap (all failures)	10%

Service Credits are applied as a deduction on the next monthly invoice. There is no earn-back mechanism: credits once accrued are not repayable on subsequent good performance.

SCHEDULE C - CHARGES

Part 1 - Recurring and One-Time Charges

Charge Item	Amount (USD)	Basis
Monthly Base Charge	184,500 per month	430-instance baseline, all towers, invoiced monthly in arrears
Transition Charge (one-time)	95,000	50% on Effective Date, 50% on Service Commencement Milestone
Additional instance	310 per instance/month	Above 430-instance baseline
Instance reduction credit	260 per instance/month	Below baseline, floor 350 instances
Volume discount	5% of Monthly Base Charge	Estate >500 instances for 3 consecutive months
Annual indexation	CPI, capped 4%	From Contract Year 2

Part 3 - Rate Card (Change and Project Work)

Role	Hourly Rate (USD)
Service Desk Analyst	85
Systems Engineer	120
Senior Systems Engineer	165
Solution Architect	195
Project Manager	145
Security Consultant	210

Rate Card rates are fixed for the Initial Term, are charged in 30-minute increments with no minimum booking, and apply without uplift to termination assistance under Clause 20.1. Out-of-hours project work (22:00-06:00 UK time) carries a 15% uplift with prior Client approval.

SCHEDULE D - SECURITY REQUIREMENTS (SUMMARY)

The Service Provider shall maintain: ISO/IEC 27001 certification scoped to the delivery organisation and facilities; an annual SOC 2 Type II report (security, availability, confidentiality); Cyber Essentials Plus for UK operations; MFA on all administrative access; privileged access via just-in-time elevation with session recording; quarterly access recertification; security awareness training for all personnel on induction and annually; and a documented secure development lifecycle for automation code. Client Data locations: primary Manchester, secondary Frankfurt, cloud regions UK South and EU Frankfurt only.

Data processing particulars (Part 3): subject matter - provision of managed IT services; duration - the Term plus 30 days; nature and purpose - hosting, monitoring, backup, support; categories of data - employee directory data, customer contact records, operational logistics data; data subjects - Client employees and customers; authorised sub-processors - as listed in Schedule A Part 5. International transfers only with Client consent and appropriate safeguards.

EXECUTED by the duly authorised representatives of the parties on the date first written above. Signed for and on behalf of Meridian Logistics Group PLC: _____ (Chief Operating Officer). Signed for and on behalf of NorthBridge Digital Services Ltd: _____ (Chief Executive Officer).